[4] Ishmaiah the Gibeonite, a mighty man among the Thirty and a leader over the Thirty; Jeremiah, Jahaziel, Johanan, and Jozabad the Gederathite; [5] Eluzai, Jerimoth, Bealiah, Shemariah, and Shephatiah the Haruphite; [6] Elkanah, Isshiah, Azarel, Joezer, and Jashobeam, who were Korahites; [7] and Joelah and Zebadiah, the sons of Jeroham from Gedor. [8] Some Gadites defected to David at his stronghold in the desert. They were mighty men of valor, trained for battle, experts with the shield and spear, whose faces were like the faces of lions and who were as swift as gazelles on the mountains: [9] Ezer the chief, Obadiah the second in command, Eliab the third, [10] Mishmannah the fourth, Jeremiah the fifth, [11] Attai the sixth, Eliel the seventh, [12] Johanan the eighth, Elzabad the ninth, [13] Jeremiah the tenth, and Machbanai the eleventh. [14] These Gadites were army commanders, the least of whom was a match for a hundred, and the greatest for a thousand. [15] These are the ones who crossed the Jordan in the first month when it was overflowing all its banks, and they put to flight all those in the valleys, both to the east and to the west. [16] Other Benjamites and some men from Judah also came to David in his stronghold. [17] And David went out to meet them, saying, "If you have come to me in peace to help me, my heart will be united with you; but if you have come to betray me to my enemies when my hands are free of violence, may the God of our fathers see it and judge you."

[18] Then the Spirit came upon Amasai, the chief of the Thirty, and he said: "We are yours, O David! We are with you, O son of Jesse! Peace, peace to you, and peace to your helpers, for your God helps you." So David received them and made them leaders of his troops. [19] Some from Manasseh defected to David when he went with the Philistines to fight against Saul. (They did not help the Philistines because the Philistine rulers consulted and sent David away, saying, "It will cost us our heads if he defects to his master Saul.") [20] When David went to Ziklag, these men of Manasseh defected to him: Adnah, Jozabad, Jediael, Michael, Jozabad, Elihu, and Zillethai, chiefs of thousands in Manasseh. [21] They helped David against the raiders, for they were all mighty men of valor and commanders in the army. [22] For at that time men came to David day after day to help him, until he had a great army, like the army of God. [23] Now these are the numbers of men armed for battle who came to David at Hebron to turn Saul's kingdom over to him, in accordance with the word of the LORD: [24] From Judah: 6,800 armed troops bearing shields and spears. [25] From Simeon: 7,100 mighty men of valor, ready for battle.

[26] From Levi: 4,600, [27] including Jehoiada, leader of the house of Aaron, with 3,700 men, [28] and Zadok, a mighty young man of valor, with 22 commanders from his own family. [29] From Benjamin, the kinsmen of Saul: 3,000, most of whom had remained loyal to the house of Saul up to that time. [30] From Ephraim: 20,800 mighty men of valor, famous among their own clans. [31] From the half-tribe of Manasseh: 18,000 designated by name to come and make David king. [32] From Issachar, men who understood the times and knew what Israel should do: 200 chiefs with all their kinsmen at their command. [33] From Zebulun: 50,000 fit for service, trained for battle with all kinds of weapons of war, who with one purpose were devoted to David. [34] From Naphtali: 1,000 commanders, accompanied by 37,000 men with shield and spear. [35] From Dan: 28,600 prepared for battle. [36] From Asher: 40,000 fit for service, prepared for battle. [37] And from east of the Jordan, from Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh there: 120,000 armed with every kind of weapon of war. [38] All these men of war, arrayed for battle, came to Hebron fully determined to make David king over all Israel. And all the rest of the Israelites were of one mind to make David king. [39] They spent three days there eating and drinking with David, for their relatives had provided for them. [40] And their neighbors from as far away as Issachar, Zebulun, and Naphtali came bringing food on donkeys, camels, mules, and oxen—abundant supplies of flour, fig cakes and raisin cakes, wine and oil, oxen and sheep. Indeed, there was joy in Israel.

13 Then David conferred with all his leaders, the commanders of hundreds and of thousands. [2] And he said to the whole assembly of Israel, "If it seems good to you, and if this is of the LORD our God, let us send word far and wide to the rest of our brothers in all the land of Israel, and also to the priests and Levites in their cities and pasturelands, so that they may join us." [3] "Then let us bring back the ark of our God, for we did not inquire of Him in the days of Saul." [4] And because this proposal seemed right to all the people, the whole assembly agreed to it. [5] So David assembled all Israel, from the River Shihor in Egypt to Lebo-hamath, to bring the ark of God from Kiriath-jearim. [6] David and all Israel went up to Baalah of Judah (that is, Kiriath-jearim) to bring up from there the ark of God the LORD, who is enthroned between the cherubim—the ark that is called by the Name. [7] So they carried the ark of God from the house of Abinadab on a new cart, with Uzzah and Ahio guiding the cart. [8] David and all the Israelites were celebrating before God with all their might, with songs and on harps and lyres, with tambourines, cymbals, and trumpets. [9] When they came to the threshing floor of Chidon, Uzzah reached out and took hold of the ark, because the oxen had stumbled. [10] And the anger of the LORD burned against Uzzah, and He struck him down because he had put his hand on the ark. So he died there before God. [11] Then David became angry because the LORD had burst forth against Uzzah; so he named that place Perez-uzzah, as it is called to this day. [12] That day David feared God and asked, "How can I ever bring the ark of God to me?" [13] So he did not move the ark with him to the City of David; instead, he took it aside to the house of Obed-edom the Gittite. [14] Thus the ark of God remained with the family of Obed-edom in his house for three months, and the LORD blessed his household and everything he owned.

14 Now Hiram king of Tyre sent envoys to David, along with cedar logs, stonemasons, and carpenters, to build a palace for him. [2] And David realized that the LORD had established him as king over Israel and had highly exalted his kingdom for the sake of His people Israel. [3] And David took more wives in Jerusalem and became the father of more sons and daughters. [4] These are the names of the children born to him in Jerusalem: Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, Solomon, [5] Ibhar, Elishua, Elpelet, [6] Nogah, Nepheg, Japhia, [7] Elishama, Beeliada, and Eliphelet. [8] When the Philistines heard that David had been anointed king over all Israel, they all went in search of him; but David learned of this and went out to face them. [9] Now the Philistines had come and raided the Valley of Rephaim.

[10] So David inquired of God, "Should I go up against the Philistines? Will You deliver them into my hand?" "Go," replied the LORD, "for I will deliver them into your hand." [11] So David and his men went up to Baal-perazim, where he defeated the Philistines and said, "Like a bursting flood, God has burst out against my enemies by my hand." So they called that place Baal-perazim. [12] There the Philistines abandoned their gods, and David ordered that they be burned in the fire. [13] Once again the Philistines raided the valley. [14] So David again inquired of God, who answered him, "Do not march up after them, but circle around them and attack them in front of the balsam trees." [15] "As soon as you hear the sound of marching in the tops of the balsam trees, move out to battle, because this will mean that God has marched out before you to strike the camp of the Philistines." [16] So David did as God had commanded him, and they struck down the army of the Philistines all the way from Gibeon to Gezer. [17] And David's fame went out into every land, and the LORD caused all nations to fear him.

15 David constructed buildings for himself in the City of David, and he prepared a place for the ark of God and pitched a tent for it. [2] Then David said, "No one but the Levites may carry the ark of God, because the LORD has chosen them to carry the ark of the LORD and to minister before Him forever." [3] And David assembled all Israel in Jerusalem to bring up the ark of the LORD to the place he had prepared for it. [4] Then he gathered together the descendants of Aaron and the Levites: [5] From the Kohathites, Uriel the chief and 120 of his relatives; [6] from the Merarites, Asaiah the chief and 220 of his relatives; [7] from the Gershomites, Joel the chief and 130 of his relatives; [8] from the Elizaphanites, Shemaiah the chief and 200 of his relatives; [9] from the Hebronites, Eliel the chief and 80 of his relatives; [10] and from the Uzzielites, Amminadab the chief and 112 of his relatives. [11] David summoned the priests Zadok and Abiathar and the Levites Uriel, Asaiah, Joel, Shemaiah, Eliel, and Amminadab. [12] And he said to them, "You are the heads of the Levitical families. You and your relatives must consecrate yourselves so that you may bring the ark of the LORD, the God of Israel, to the place I have prepared for it." [13] "It was because you Levites were not with us the first time that the LORD our God burst forth in anger against us. For we did not consult Him about the proper order."

[14] So the priests and Levites consecrated themselves to bring up the ark of the LORD, the God of Israel. [15] And the Levites carried the ark of God on their shoulders with the poles, as Moses had commanded in accordance with the word of the LORD. [16] David also told the leaders of the Levites to appoint their relatives as singers to lift up their voices with joy, accompanied by musical instruments—harps, lyres, and cymbals. [17] So the Levites appointed Heman son of Joel; from his brothers, Asaph son of Berechiah; from their brothers the Merarites, Ethan son of Kushaiah; [18] and with them their brothers next in rank: Zechariah, Jaaziel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Unni, Eliab, Benaiah, Maaseiah, Mattithiah, Eliphelehu, Mikneiah, and the gatekeepers Obed-edom and Jeiel.

[19] The musicians Heman, Asaph, and Ethan were to sound the bronze cymbals. [20] Zechariah, Aziel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Unni, Eliab, Maaseiah, and Benaiah were to play the harps according to Alamoth. [21] And Mattithiah, Eliphelehu, Mikneiah, Obed-edom, Jeiel, and Azaziah were to lead the music with lyres according to Sheminith. [22] Chenaniah the head Levite was the director of the music because he was highly skilled. [23] Berechiah and Elkanah were to be guardians of the ark. [24] Shebaniah, Joshaphat, Nethanel, Amasai, Zechariah, Benaiah, and Eliezer—the priests—were to blow the trumpets before the ark of God. Obed-edom and Jehiah were also to be guardians of the ark. [25] So David, the elders of Israel, and the commanders of thousands went with rejoicing to bring the ark of the covenant of the LORD from the house of Obed-edom. [26] And because God helped the Levites who were carrying the ark of the covenant of the LORD, they sacrificed seven bulls and seven rams. [27] Now David was dressed in a robe of fine linen, as were all the Levites who were carrying the ark, as well as the singers and Chenaniah, the director of music for the singers. David also wore a linen ephod. [28] So all Israel brought up the ark of the covenant of the LORD with shouting, with the sounding of rams' horns and trumpets, and with cymbals and the music of harps and lyres. [29] As the ark of the covenant of the LORD was entering the City of David, Saul's daughter

Michal looked down from a window and saw King David dancing and celebrating, and she despised him in her heart.

16 So they brought the ark of God and placed it inside the tent that David had pitched for it. And they presented burnt offerings and peace offerings before God. [2] When David had finished sacrificing the burnt offerings and peace offerings, he blessed the people in the name of the LORD. [3] Then he distributed to every man and woman of Israel a loaf of bread, a date cake, and a raisin cake. [4] David appointed some of the Levites to minister before the ark of the LORD, to celebrate, to give thanks, and to praise the LORD, the God of Israel. [5] Asaph was the chief, Zechariah was second, then Jeiel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Mattithiah, Eliab, Benaiah, Obed-edom, and Jeiel. They were to play the harps and lyres, while Asaph sounded the cymbals [6] and the priests Benaiah and Jahaziel blew the trumpets regularly before the ark of the covenant of God. [7] On that day David first committed to Asaph and his brothers this song of thanksgiving to the LORD: [8] "Give thanks to the LORD; call upon His name; make known His deeds among the nations." [9] Sing to Him, sing praises to Him; tell of all His wonders. [10] Glory in His holy name; let the hearts of those who seek the LORD rejoice. [11] Seek out the LORD and His strength; seek His face always. [12] Remember the wonders He has done, His marvels, and the judgments He has pronounced, [13] O offspring of His servant Israel, O sons of Jacob, His chosen ones.

[14] He is the LORD our God; His judgments carry throughout the earth. [15] Remember His covenant forever, the word He ordained for a thousand generations— [16] the covenant He made with Abraham, and the oath He swore to Isaac. [17] He confirmed it to Jacob as a decree, to Israel as an everlasting covenant: [18] 'I will give you the land of Canaan as the portion of your inheritance.' [19] When they were few in number, few indeed, and strangers in the land, [20] they wandered from nation to nation, from one kingdom to another. [21] He let no man oppress them; He rebuked kings on their behalf: [22] 'Do not touch My anointed ones! Do no harm to My prophets!' [23] Sing to the LORD, all the earth. Proclaim His salvation day after day. [24] Declare His glory among the nations, His wonderful deeds among all peoples. [25] For great is the LORD, and greatly to be praised; He is to be feared above all gods. [26] For all the gods of the nations are idols, but it is the LORD who made the heavens. [27] Splendor and majesty are before Him; strength and joy fill His dwelling.

[28] Ascribe to the LORD, O families of the nations, ascribe to the LORD glory and strength. [29] Ascribe to the LORD the glory due His name; bring an offering and come before Him. Worship the LORD in the splendor of His holiness; [30] tremble before Him, all the earth. The world is firmly established; it cannot be moved. [31] Let the heavens be glad, and the earth rejoice. Let them say among the nations, 'The LORD reigns!' [32] Let the sea resound, and all that fills it; let the fields exult, and all that is in them. [33] Then the trees of the forest will sing for joy before the LORD, for He is coming to judge the earth. [34] Give thanks to the LORD, for He is good; His loving devotion endures forever. [35] Then cry out: 'Save us, O God of our salvation; gather and deliver us from the nations, that we may give thanks to Your holy name, that we may glory in Your praise.' [36] "Blessed be the LORD, the God of Israel, from everlasting to everlasting." Then all the people said, "Amen!" and "Praise the LORD!"

[37] So David left Asaph and his brothers there before the ark of the covenant of the LORD, to minister there regularly according to the daily requirements, [38] along with Obed-edom and his sixty-eight relatives. Obed-edom son of Jeduthun, and also Hosah, were to be gatekeepers. [39] And David left Zadok the priest and his fellow priests before the tabernacle of the LORD at the high place in Gibeon [40] to regularly present burnt offerings to the LORD on the altar of burnt offerings, morning and evening, according to all that was written in the Law of the LORD, which He had commanded Israel to keep. [41] With them were Heman, Jeduthun, and the rest of those chosen and designated by name to give thanks to the LORD, for "His loving devotion endures forever." [42] Heman and Jeduthun had with them trumpets and cymbals for the music and instruments for the songs of God. And the sons of Jeduthun were stationed at the gate. [43] Then all the people departed for their homes, and David returned home to bless his household.

17 After David had settled into his palace, he said to Nathan the prophet, "Here I am, living in a house of cedar, while the ark of the covenant of the LORD is under a tent." [2] And Nathan replied to David, "Do all that is in your heart, for God is with you." [3] But that night the word of God came to Nathan, saying, [4] "Go and tell My servant David that this is what the LORD says: You are not the one to build Me a house in which to dwell." [5] For I have not dwelt in a house from the day I brought Israel up out of Egypt until this day, but I have moved from tent to tent and dwelling to dwelling. [6] In all My journeys with all the Israelites, have I ever asked any of the leaders I appointed to shepherd My people, 'Why haven't you built Me a house of cedar?' [7] Now then, you are to tell My servant David that this is what the LORD of Hosts says: I took you from the pasture, from following the flock, to be the ruler over My people Israel. [8] I have been with you wherever you have gone, and I have cut off all your enemies from before you. Now I will make for you a name like the greatest in the land.

[9] And I will provide a place for My people Israel and will plant them so that they may dwell in a place of their own and be disturbed no more. No longer will the sons of wickedness oppress them as they did at the beginning [10] and have done since the day I appointed judges over My people Israel. And I will subdue all your enemies. Moreover, I declare to you that the LORD will build a house for you. [11] And when your days are fulfilled and you go to be with your fathers, I will raise up your descendant after you, one of your own sons, and I will establish his kingdom.

[12] He will build a house for Me, and I will establish his throne forever. [13] I will be his Father, and he will be My son. And I will never remove My loving devotion from him as I removed it from your predecessor. [14] "But I will set him over My house and My kingdom forever, and his throne will be established forever." [15] So Nathan relayed to David all the words of this entire vision. [16] Then King David went in, sat before the LORD, and said, "Who am I, O LORD God, and what is my house, that You have brought me this far?" [17] And as if this was a small thing in Your eyes, O God, You have spoken about the future of the house of Your servant and have regarded me as a man of great distinction, O LORD God.

[18] What more can David say to You for so honoring Your servant? For You know Your servant, [19] O LORD. For the sake of Your servant and according to Your own heart, You have accomplished this great thing and revealed all Your greatness. [20] O LORD, there is none like You, and there is no God but You, according to everything we have heard with our own ears. [21] And who is like Your people Israel —the one nation on earth whom God went out to redeem as a people for Himself? You made a name for Yourself through great and awesome wonders by driving out nations from before Your people, whom You redeemed from Egypt. [22] For You have made Your people Israel Your very own forever, and You, O LORD, have become their God. [23] And now, O LORD, let the word You have spoken concerning Your servant and his house be established forever. Do as You have promised, [24] so that Your name will be established and magnified forever when it is said, 'The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, is God over Israel.' And may the house of Your servant David be established before You. [25] For You, my God, have revealed to Your servant that You will build a house for him. Therefore Your servant has found the courage to pray before You. [26] And now, O LORD, You are God! And You have promised this goodness to Your servant. [27] "So now You have been pleased to bless the house of Your servant, that it may continue forever before You. For You, O LORD, have blessed it, and it will be blessed forever."

18 Some time later, David defeated the Philistines, subdued them, and took Gath and its villages from the hand of the Philistines. [2] David also defeated the Moabites, and they became subject to David and brought him tribute. [3] As far as Hamath, David also defeated King Hadadezer of Zobah, who had marched out to establish his dominion along the Euphrates River. [4] David captured from him a thousand chariots, seven thousand charioteers, and twenty thousand foot soldiers, and he hamstrung all the horses except a hundred he kept for the chariots. [5] When the Arameans of Damascus came to help King Hadadezer of Zobah, David struck down twenty-two thousand men. [6] Then he placed garrisons in Aram of Damascus, and the Arameans became subject to David and brought him tribute. So the LORD made David victorious wherever he went. [7] And David took the gold shields that belonged to the officers of Hadadezer and brought them to Jerusalem.

[8] And from Tibhath and Cun, cities of Hadadezer, David took a large amount of bronze, with which Solomon made the bronze Sea, the pillars, and various bronze articles. [9] When King Tou of Hamath heard that David had defeated the entire army of Hadadezer king of Zobah, [10] he sent his son Hadoram to greet King David and bless him for fighting and defeating Hadadezer, who had been at war with Tou. Hadoram brought all kinds of articles of gold and silver and bronze, [11] and King David dedicated these to the LORD, along with the silver and gold he had carried off from all these nations—from Edom and Moab, and from the Ammonites, Philistines, and Amalekites. [12] Moreover, Abishai son of Zeruiah struck down eighteen thousand Edomites in the Valley of Salt. [13] He placed garrisons in Edom, and all the Edomites were subject to David. So the LORD made David victorious wherever he went. [14] Thus David reigned over all Israel and administered justice and righteousness for all his people: [15] Joab son of Zeruiah was over the army; Jehoshaphat son of Ahilud was the recorder; [16] Zadok son of Ahitub and Ahimelech son of Abiathar were priests; Shavsha was the scribe; [17] Benaiah son of Jehoiada was over the Cherethites and Pelethites; and David's sons were chief officials at the king's side.

19 Some time later, Nahash king of the Ammonites died and was succeeded by his son. [2] And David said, "I will show kindness to Hanun son of Nahash, because his father showed kindness to me." So David sent messengers to console Hanun concerning his father. But when David's servants arrived in the land of the Ammonites to console him, [3] the princes of the Ammonites said to Hanun, "Just because David has sent you comforters, do you really believe he is showing respect for your father? Have not his servants come to you to explore the land, spy it out, and overthrow it?" [4] So Hanun took David's servants, shaved their beards, cut off their garments at the hips, and sent them away. [5] When someone came and told David about his men, he sent messengers to meet them, since the men had been

thoroughly humiliated. The king told them, "Stay in Jericho until your beards have grown back, and then return." [6] When the Ammonites realized that they had become a stench to David, Hanun and the Ammonites sent a thousand talents of silver to hire for themselves chariots and horsemen from Aram-naharaim, Aram-maacah, and Zobah. [7] So they hired for themselves thirty-two thousand chariots, as well as the king of Maacah with his troops, who came and camped near Medeba while the Ammonites came from their cities and marched out for battle. [8] On hearing this, David sent Joab and the entire army of mighty men. [9] The Ammonites marched out and arrayed themselves for battle at the entrance to the city, while the kings who had come stayed by themselves in the open country. [10] When Joab saw the battle lines before him and behind him, he selected some of the best men of Israel and arrayed them against the Arameans. [11] And he placed the rest of the forces under the command of his brother Abishai, who arrayed them against the Ammonites.

[12] "If the Arameans are too strong for me," said Joab, "then you will come to my rescue. And if the Ammonites are too strong for you, then I will come to your rescue." [13] "Be strong and let us fight bravely for our people and for the cities of our God. May the LORD do what is good in His sight." [14] So Joab and his troops advanced to fight the Arameans, who fled before him. [15] When the Ammonites saw that the Arameans had fled, they too fled before Joab's brother Abishai, and they entered the city. So Joab went back to Jerusalem. [16] When the Arameans saw that they had been defeated by Israel, they sent messengers to bring more Arameans from beyond the Euphrates, with Shophach the commander of Hadadezer's army leading them. [17] When this was reported to David, he gathered all Israel, crossed the Jordan, advanced toward the Arameans, and arrayed for battle against them. When David lined up to engage them in battle, they fought against him. [18] But the Arameans fled before Israel, and David killed seven thousand of their charioteers and forty thousand foot soldiers. He also killed Shophach the commander of their army. [19] When Hadadezer's subjects saw that they had been defeated by Israel, they made peace with David and became subject to him. So the Arameans were unwilling to help the Ammonites anymore.

20 In the spring, at the time when kings march out to war, Joab led out the army and ravaged the land of the Ammonites. He came to Rabbah and besieged it, but David remained in Jerusalem. And Joab attacked Rabbah and demolished it. [2] Then David took the crown from the head of their king. It was found to weigh a talent of gold and was set with precious stones, and it was placed on David's head. And David took a great amount of plunder from the city. [3] David brought out the people who were there and put them to work with saws, iron picks, and axes. And he did the same to all the Ammonite cities. Then David and all his troops returned to Jerusalem. [4] Some time later, war broke out with the Philistines at Gezer. At that time Sibbecai the Hushathite killed Sippai, a descendant of the Rephaim, and the Philistines were subdued. [5] Once again there was a battle with the Philistines, and Elhanan son of Jair killed Lahmi the brother of Goliath the Gittite, the shaft of whose spear was like a weaver's beam. [6] And there was still another battle at Gath, where there was a man of great stature with six fingers on each hand and six toes on each foot—twenty-four in all. He too was descended from Rapha, [7] and when he taunted Israel, Jonathan the son of David's brother Shimei killed him. [8] So these descendants of Rapha in Gath fell at the hands of David and his servants.

21 Then Satan rose up against Israel and incited David to take a census of Israel. [2] So David said to Joab and the commanders of the troops, "Go and count the Israelites from Beersheba to Dan and bring me a report, so that I may know their number." [3] But Joab replied, "May the LORD multiply His troops a hundred times over. My lord the king, are they not all servants of my lord? Why does my lord want to do this? Why should he bring guilt on Israel?" [4] Nevertheless, the king's word prevailed against Joab. So Joab departed and traveled throughout Israel, and then he returned to Jerusalem. [5] And Joab reported to David the total number of the troops. In all Israel there were 1,100,000 men who drew the sword, including 470,000 in Judah. [6] But Joab did not include Levi and Benjamin in the count, because the king's command was detestable to him. [7] This command was also evil in the sight of God; so He struck Israel. [8] Then David said to God, "I have sinned greatly because I have done this thing. Now I beg You to take away the iniquity of Your servant, for I have acted very foolishly." [9] And the LORD instructed Gad, David's seer, [10] "Go and tell David that this is what the LORD says: 'I am offering you three options. Choose one of them, and I will carry it out against you.'" [11] So Gad went and said to David, "This is what the LORD says: 'You must choose'" [12] "between three years of famine, three months of being swept away before your enemies and overtaken by their swords, or three days of the sword of the LORD—days of plague upon the land, with the angel of the LORD ravaging every part of Israel.' Now then, decide how I should reply to Him who sent me."

[13] David answered Gad, "I am deeply distressed. Please, let me fall into the hand of the LORD, for His mercies are very great; but do not let me fall into the hands of men." [14] So the LORD sent a plague upon Israel, and seventy thousand men of Israel fell dead. [15] Then God sent an angel to destroy Jerusalem, but as the angel was doing so, the LORD saw it and relented from the calamity, and He said to the angel who was destroying the people, "Enough! Withdraw your hand now!" At that time the angel of the LORD was standing by the threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite. [16] When David lifted up his eyes and saw the angel of the LORD standing between heaven and earth, with a drawn sword in his hand stretched out over Jerusalem, David and the elders, clothed in sackcloth, fell facedown. [17] And David said to God, "Was it not I who gave the order to count the people? I am the one who has sinned and acted wickedly. But these sheep, what have they done? O LORD my God, please let Your hand fall upon me and my father's house, but do not let this plague remain upon Your people." [18] Then the angel of the LORD ordered Gad to tell David to go up and build an altar to the LORD on the threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite. [19] So David went up at the word that Gad had spoken in the name of the LORD.

[20] Now Ornan was threshing wheat when he turned and saw the angel; and his four sons who were with him hid themselves. [21] David came to Ornan, and when Ornan looked out and saw David, he left the threshing floor and bowed facedown before David. [22] Then David said to Ornan, "Grant me the site of this threshing floor, that I may build an altar to the LORD. Sell it to me for the full price, so that the plague upon the people may be halted." [23] Ornan said to David, "My lord the king may take whatever seems good. Look, I will give the oxen for the burnt offerings, the threshing sledges for the wood, and the wheat for the grain offering—I will give it all." [24] "No," replied King David, "I insist on paying the full price, for I will not take for the LORD what belongs to you, nor will I offer burnt offerings that cost me nothing." [25] So David paid Ornan six hundred shekels of gold for the site. [26] And there he built an altar to the LORD and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings. He called upon the LORD, who answered him with fire from heaven on the altar of burnt offering. [27] Then the LORD spoke to the angel, who put his sword back into its sheath. [28] At that time, when David saw that the LORD had answered him at the threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite, he offered sacrifices there. [29] For the tabernacle of the LORD that Moses had made in the wilderness and the altar of burnt offering were presently at the high place in Gibeon, [30] but David could not go before it to inquire of God, because he was afraid of the sword of the angel of the LORD.

22 Then David said, "Here shall be the house of the LORD God, as well as the altar of burnt offering for Israel." [2] So David gave orders to gather the foreigners in the land of Israel, from whom he appointed stonecutters to prepare finished stones for building the house of God. [3] David provided a large quantity of iron to make the nails for the doors of the gateways and for the fittings, together with more bronze than could be weighed [4] and more cedar logs than could be counted; for the Sidonians and Tyrians had brought a large quantity of cedar logs to David. [5] And David said, "My son Solomon is young and inexperienced, and the house to be built for the LORD must be exceedingly magnificent—famous and glorious throughout all lands. Therefore I must make preparations for it." So David made lavish preparations before his death. [6] Then David called for his son Solomon and instructed him to build a house for the LORD, the God of Israel. [7] "My son," said David to Solomon, "it was in my heart to build a house for the Name of the LORD my God," [8] but this word of the LORD came to me: 'You have shed much blood and waged great wars. You are not to build a house for My Name because you have shed so much blood on the ground before Me.' [9] But a son will be born to you who will be a man of rest. I will give him rest from all his enemies on every side; for his name will be Solomon, and I will grant to Israel peace and quiet during his reign. [10] He is the one who will build a house for My Name. He will be My son, and I will be his Father. And I will establish the throne of his kingdom over Israel forever.' [11] Now, my son, may the LORD be with you, and may you succeed in building the house of the LORD your God, as He said you would. [12] Above all, may the LORD give you insight and understanding when He puts you in command over Israel, so that you may keep the Law of the LORD your God.

[13] Then you will succeed, if you carefully follow the statutes and ordinances that the LORD commanded Moses for Israel. Be strong and courageous. Do not be afraid or discouraged. [14] Now behold, I have taken great pains to provide for the house of the LORD—100,000 talents of gold, 1,000,000 talents of silver, and bronze and iron too great to be weighed. I have also provided timber and stone, and you may add to them. [15] You also have many workers: stonecutters, masons, carpenters, and men skilled in every kind of work— [16] "in gold and silver, bronze and iron—craftsmen beyond number. Now begin the work, and may the LORD be with you." [17] Then David ordered all the leaders of Israel to help his son Solomon: [18] "Is not the LORD your God with you, and has He not granted you rest on every side? For He has given the inhabitants of the land into my hand, and the land has been subdued before the LORD and His people." [19] "Now set your heart and soul to seek the LORD your God. Get started building the sanctuary of the LORD God, so that you may bring the ark of the covenant of the LORD and the holy articles of God into the temple that will be built for the Name of the LORD."

23 When David was old and full of years, he installed his son Solomon as king over Israel. [2] Then he gathered all the leaders of Israel, as well as the priests and Levites. [3] The Levites thirty years of age or older were counted, and the total number of men was 38,000. [4] "Of these," said David, "24,000 are to oversee the work of the house of the LORD, 6,000 are to be officers and judges," [5] "4,000 are to be gatekeepers, and 4,000 are to praise the LORD with the instruments I have made

for giving praise." [6] Then David divided the Levites into divisions according to the sons of Levi: Gershom, Kohath, and Merari. [7] The Gershonites: Ladan and Shimei. [8] The sons of Ladan: Jehiel the first, Zetham, and Joel—three in all. [9] The sons of Shimei: Shelomoth, Haziel, and Haran—three in all. These were the heads of the families of Ladan.

[10] And the sons of Shimei: Jahath, Zina, Jeush, and Beriah. These were the sons of Shimei—four in all. [11] Jahath was the first and Zizah was the second; but Jeush and Beriah did not have many sons, so they were counted as one family and received a single assignment. [12] The sons of Kohath: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel—four in all. [13] The sons of Amram: Aaron and Moses. Aaron and his descendants were set apart forever to consecrate the most holy things, to burn incense before the LORD, to minister before Him, and to pronounce blessings in His name forever.

[14] As for Moses the man of God, his sons were named among the tribe of Levi. [15] The sons of Moses: Gershom and Eliezer. [16] The descendants of Gershom: Shebuel was the first. [17] The descendants of Eliezer: Rehabiah was the first. Eliezer did not have any other sons, but the sons of Rehabiah were very numerous. [18] The sons of Izhar: Shelomith was the first. [19] The sons of Hebron: Jeriah was the first, Amariah the second, Jahaziel the third, and Jekameam the fourth. [20] The sons of Uzziel: Micah was the first and Isshiah the second.

[21] The sons of Merari: Mahli and Mushi. [22] The sons of Mahli: Eleazar and Kish. Eleazar died without having any sons; he had only daughters. Their cousins, the sons of Kish, married them. [23] The sons of Mushi: Mahli, Eder, and Jeremoth—three in all. [24] These were the descendants of Levi by their families—the heads of families, registered individually by name—those twenty years of age or older who worked in the service of the house of the LORD. [25] For David had said, "The LORD, the God of Israel, has given rest to His people and has come to dwell in Jerusalem forever." [26] "So now the Levites no longer need to carry the tabernacle or any of the articles for its service." [27] For according to the final instructions of David, the Levites twenty years of age or older were counted, [28] but their duty was to assist the descendants of Aaron with the service of the house of the LORD, being responsible for the courts and chambers, the purification of all the holy things, and the work of the service of the house of God, [29] as well as for the rows of the showbread, the fine flour for the grain offering, the wafers of unleavened bread, the baking, the mixing, and all measurements of quantity and size. [30] They were also to stand every morning to give thanks and praise to the LORD, and likewise in the evening. [31] Whenever burnt offerings were presented to the LORD on the Sabbaths, New Moons, and appointed feasts, they were to serve regularly before the LORD in the numbers prescribed for them. [32] So the Levites were to carry out the responsibilities for the Tent of Meeting and the Holy Place, and, under their brothers the descendants of Aaron, the service of the house of the LORD.

24 These were the divisions of the descendants of Aaron. The sons of Aaron were Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar. [2] But Nadab and Abihu died before their father did, and they had no sons; so Eleazar and Ithamar served as priests. [3] With the help of Eleazar's descendant Zadok and Ithamar's descendant Ahimelech, David divided them according to the offices of their service. [4] Since more leaders were found among Eleazar's descendants than those of Ithamar, they were divided accordingly. There were sixteen heads of families from the descendants of Eleazar and eight from the descendants of Ithamar. [5] Thus they were divided by lot, for there were officers of the sanctuary and officers of God among both Eleazar's and Ithamar's descendants. [6] The scribe, Shemaiah son of Nethanel, a Levite, recorded their names in the presence of the king and of the officers: Zadok the priest, Ahimelech son of Abiathar, and the heads of families of the priests and the Levites—one family being taken from Eleazar, and then one from Ithamar. [7] The first lot fell to Jehoiarib, the second to Jedaiah, [8] the third to Harim, the fourth to Seorim, [9] the fifth to Malchijah, the sixth to Mijamin, [10] the seventh to Hakkoz, the eighth to Abijah, [11] the ninth to Jeshua, the tenth to Shecaniah, [12] the eleventh to Eliashib, the twelfth to Jakim, [13] the thirteenth to Huppah, the fourteenth to Jeshebeab, [14] the fifteenth to Bilgah, the sixteenth to Immer, [15] the seventeenth to Hezir, the eighteenth to Happizzez, [16] the nineteenth to Pethahiah, the twentieth to Jehezkel, [17] the twenty-first to Jachin, the twenty-second to Gamul, [18] the twenty-third to Delaiah, and the twenty-fourth to Maaziah.

[19] This was their appointed order for service when they entered the house of the LORD, according to the regulations prescribed for them by their forefather Aaron, as the LORD, the God of Israel, had commanded him.

[20] Now these were the remaining descendants of Levi: From the sons of Amram: Shubael; from the sons of Shubael: Jehdeiah. [21] As for Rehabiah, from his sons: The first was Isshiah. [22] From the Izharites: Shelomoth; from the sons of Shelomoth: Jahath. [23] From the sons of Hebron: Jeriah was the first, Amariah the second, Jahaziel the third, and Jekameam the fourth. [24] From the sons of Uzziel: Micah; from the sons of Micah: Shamir. [25] The brother of Micah: Isshiah; from the sons of Isshiah: Zechariah. [26] The sons of Merari: Mahli and Mushi. The son of Jaaziah: Beno. [27] The descendants of Merari from Jaaziah: Beno, Shoham, Zaccur, and Ibri. [28] From Mahli: Eleazar, who had no sons. [29] From Kish: Jerahmeel the son of Kish. [30] And the sons of Mushi: Mahli, Eder, and Jerimoth. These were the sons of the Levites, according to their families. [31] As their brothers the descendants of Aaron did, they also cast lots in the presence of King David and of Zadok, Ahimelech, and the heads of the families of the priests and Levites—the family heads and their younger brothers alike.

25 Additionally, David and the commanders of the army set apart some of the sons of Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun to prophesy with the accompaniment of lyres, harps, and cymbals. The following is the list of the men who performed this service: [2] From the sons of Asaph: Zaccur, Joseph, Nethaniah, and Asarelah. These sons of Asaph were under the direction of Asaph, who prophesied under the direction of the king. [3] From the sons of Jeduthun: Gedaliah, Zeri, Jeshaiah, Shimei, Hashabiah, and Mattithiah—six in all—under the direction of their father Jeduthun, who prophesied with the harp, giving thanks and praise to the LORD. [4] From the sons of Heman: Bukkiah, Mattaniah, Uzziel, Shebuel, Jerimoth, Hananiah, Hanani, Eliathah, Giddalti, Romamti-ezer, Joshbekashah, Mallothi, Hothir, and Mahazioth. [5] All these sons of Heman the king's seer were given him through the promises of God to exalt him, for God had given Heman fourteen sons and three daughters. [6] All these were under the direction of their fathers for the music of the house of the LORD with cymbals, harps, and lyres, for the service of the house of God. Asaph, Jeduthun, and Heman were under the direction of the king. [7] Together with their relatives, who were all trained and skillful in the songs of the LORD, they numbered 288. [8] They cast lots for their duties, young and old alike, teacher as well as pupil. [9] The first lot, which was for Asaph, fell to Joseph, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; the second to Gedaliah, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [10] the third to Zaccur, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [11] the fourth to Izri, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [12] the fifth to Nethaniah, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [13] the sixth to Bukkiah, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [14] the seventh to Jesarelah, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [15] the eighth to Jeshaiah, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [16] the ninth to Mattaniah, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [17] the tenth to Shimei, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [18] the eleventh to Azarel, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [19] the twelfth to Hashabiah, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [20] the thirteenth to Shubael, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [21] the fourteenth to Mattithiah, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [22] the fifteenth to Jeremoth, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [23] the sixteenth to Hananiah, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [24] the seventeenth to Joshbekashah, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [25] the eighteenth to Hanani, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [26] the nineteenth to Mallothi, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [27] the twentieth to Eliathah, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [28] the twenty-first to Hothir, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [29] the twenty-second to Giddalti, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [30] the twenty-third to Mahazioth, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all; [31] and the twenty-fourth to Romamti-ezer, his sons, and his brothers—12 in all.

26 These were the divisions of the gatekeepers: From the Korahites: Meshelemiah son of Kore, one of the sons of Asaph. [2] Meshelemiah had sons: Zechariah the firstborn, Jediael the second, Zebadiah the third, Jathniel the fourth, [3] Elam the fifth, Jehohanan the sixth, and Eliehoenai the seventh. [4] And Obed-edom also had sons: Shemaiah the firstborn, Jehozabad the second, Joah the third, Sachar the fourth, Nethanel the fifth, [5] Ammiel the sixth, Issachar the seventh, and Peullethai the eighth. For God had blessed Obed-edom. [6] Also to his son Shemaiah were born sons who ruled over their families because they were strong, capable men. [7] Shemaiah's sons were Othni, Rephael, Obed, and Elzabad; his brothers were Elihu and Semachiah, also capable men. [8] All these were descendants of Obed-edom; they and their sons and brothers were capable men with strength to do the work—62 in all from Obed-edom. [9] Meshelemiah also had sons and brothers who were capable men—18 in all.

[10] Hosah the Merarite also had sons: Shimri the first (although he was not the firstborn, his father had appointed him as the first), [11] Hilkiah the second, Tebaliah the third, and Zechariah the fourth. The sons and brothers of Hosah numbered 13 in all. [12] These divisions of the gatekeepers, through their chief men, had duties for ministering in the house of the LORD, just as their brothers did. [13] They cast lots for each gate, according to their families, young and old alike.

[14] The lot for the East Gate fell to Shelemiah. Then lots were cast for his son Zechariah, a wise counselor, and the lot for the North Gate fell to him. [15] The lot for the South Gate fell to Obed-edom, and the lot for the storehouses to his sons. [16] The lots for the West Gate and the Shallecheth Gate on the ascending highway fell to Shuppim and Hosah. There were guards stationed at every watch. [17] Each day there were six Levites on the east, four on the north, four on the south, and two pairs at the storehouse. [18] As for the court on the west, there were four at the highway and two at the court. [19] These were the divisions of the gatekeepers who were descendants of Korah and Merari. [20] Now their fellow Levites were in charge of the treasuries of the house of God and the treasuries of the dedicated things.

[21] From the descendants of Ladan, who were Gershonites through Ladan and heads of the families of Ladan the Gershonite, were Jehieli, [22] the sons of Jehieli, Zetham, and his brother Joel. They were in charge of the treasuries of the house of the LORD. [23] From the Amramites, the Izharites, the Hebronites, and

the Uzzielites: [24] Shebuel, a descendant of Gershom son of Moses, was the officer in charge of the treasuries. [25] His relatives through Eliezer included Rehabiah his son, Jeshaiah his son, Joram his son, Zichri his son, and Shelomith his son. [26] This Shelomith and his brothers were in charge of all the treasuries for the things dedicated by King David, by the heads of families who were the commanders of thousands and of hundreds, and by the army commanders. [27] They had dedicated some of the plunder from their battles to the repair of the house of the LORD. [28] Everything that had been dedicated by Samuel the seer, Saul son of Kish, Abner son of Ner, and Joab son of Zeruiah, along with everything else that was dedicated, was under the care of Shelomith and his brothers. [29] From the Izharites, Chenaniah and his sons had the outside duties as officers and judges over Israel. [30] From the Hebronites, Hashabiah and his relatives, 1,700 capable men, had charge of the affairs of Israel west of the Jordan for all the work of the LORD and for the service of the king. [31] As for the Hebronites, Jerijah was the chief of the Hebronites, according to the genealogies of his ancestors. In the fortieth year of David's reign the records were searched, and strong, capable men were found among the Hebronites at Jazer in Gilead. [32] Among Jerijah's relatives there were 2,700 capable men who were heads of families. King David appointed them over the Reubenites, the Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh for every matter pertaining to God and to the affairs of the king.

27 This is the list of the Israelites—the heads of families, the commanders of thousands and of hundreds, and their officers who served the king in every matter concerning the divisions on rotating military duty each month throughout the year. There were 24,000 men in each division: [2] Jashobeam son of Zabdiel was in charge of the first division, which was assigned the first month. There were 24,000 men in his division. [3] He was a descendant of Perez and chief of all the army commanders for the first month. [4] Dodai the Ahohite was in charge of the division for the second month, and Mikloth was the leader. There were 24,000 men in his division. [5] The third army commander, as chief for the third month, was Benaiah son of Jehoiada the priest. There were 24,000 men in his division. [6] This Benaiah was mighty among the Thirty and was over the Thirty, and his son Ammizabad was in charge of his division. [7] The fourth, for the fourth month, was Joab's brother Asahel, and his son Zebadiah was commander after him. There were 24,000 men in his division. [8] The fifth, for the fifth month, was the commander Shamhuth the Izrahite. There were 24,000 men in his division. [9] The sixth, for the sixth month, was Ira son of Ikkesh the Tekoite. There were 24,000 men in his division. [10] The seventh, for the seventh month, was Helez the Pelonite, an Ephraimite. There were 24,000 men in his division.

[11] The eighth, for the eighth month, was Sibbecai the Hushathite, a Zerahite. There were 24,000 men in his division. [12] The ninth, for the ninth month, was Abiezer the Anathothite, a Benjamite. There were 24,000 men in his division. [13] The tenth, for the tenth month, was Maharai the Netophathite, a Zerahite. There were 24,000 men in his division. [14] The eleventh, for the eleventh month, was Benaiah the Pirathonite, an Ephraimite. There were 24,000 men in his division.

[15] The twelfth, for the twelfth month, was Heldai the Netophathite, from the family of Othniel. There were 24,000 men in his division. [16] These officers were in charge of the tribes of Israel: Over the Reubenites was Eliezer son of Zichri; over the Simeonites was Shephatiah son of Maacah; [17] over Levi was Hashabiah son of Kemuel; over Aaron was Zadok; [18] over Judah was Elihu, one of David's brothers; over Issachar was Omri son of Michael; [19] over Zebulun was Ishmaiah son of Obadiah; over Naphtali was Jerimoth son of Azriel; [20] over the Ephraimites was Hoshea son of Azaziah; over one of the half-tribes of Manasseh was Joel son of Pedaiah; [21] over the half-tribe of Manasseh in Gilead was Iddo son of Zechariah; over Benjamin was Jaasiel son of Abner; [22] and over Dan was Azarel son of Jeroham. These were the leaders of the tribes of Israel. [23] David did not count the men aged twenty or under, because the LORD had said that He would make Israel as numerous as the stars of the sky. [24] Joab son of Zeruiah began to count the men but did not finish. For because of this census wrath came upon Israel, and the number was not entered in the Book of the Chronicles of King David. [25] Azmaveth son of Adiel was in charge of the royal storehouses. Jonathan son of Uzziah was in charge of the storehouses in the country, in the cities, in the villages, and in the fortresses. [26] Ezri son of Chelub was in charge of the workers in the fields who tilled the soil. [27] Shimei the Ramathite was in charge of the vineyards. Zabdi the Shiphmite was in charge of the produce of the vineyards for the wine vats. [28] Baal-hanan the Gederite was in charge of the olive and sycamore trees in the foothills. Joash was in charge of the stores of olive oil. [29] Shitrai the Sharonite was in charge of the herds grazing in Sharon. Shaphat son of Adlai was in charge of the herds in the valleys. [30] Obil the Ishmaelite was in charge of the camels. Jehdeiah the Meronothite was in charge of the donkeys. [31] Jaziz the Hagrite was in charge of the flocks. All these officials were in charge of King David's property. [32] David's uncle Jonathan was a counselor; he was a man of insight and a scribe. Jehiel son of Hachmoni attended to the sons of the king. [33] Ahithophel was the king's counselor. Hushai the Archite was the king's friend. [34] Ahithophel was succeeded by Jehoiada son of Benaiah, then by Abiathar. Joab was the commander of the king's army.

28 Now David summoned all the leaders of Israel to Jerusalem: the leaders of the tribes, the leaders of the divisions in the king's service, the commanders of thousands and of hundreds, and the officials in charge of all the property and cattle of the king and his sons, along with the court officials and mighty men—every mighty man of valor. [2] Then King David rose to his feet and said, "Listen to me, my brothers and my people. It was in my heart to build a house as a resting place for the ark of the covenant of the LORD and as a footstool for our God. I had made preparations to build it," [3] but God said to me, 'You are not to build a house for My Name, because you are a man of war who has spilled blood.' [4] Yet the LORD, the God of Israel, chose me out of all my father's house to be king over Israel forever. For He chose Judah as leader, and from the house of Judah He chose my father's household, and from my father's sons He was pleased to make me king over all Israel. [5] And of all my sons—for the LORD has given me many sons—He has chosen Solomon my son to sit on the throne of the kingdom of the LORD over Israel. [6] And He said to me, 'Solomon your son is the one who will build My house and My courts, for I have chosen him as My son, and I will be his Father.'

[7] I will establish his kingdom forever, if he resolutely carries out My commandments and ordinances, as is being done this day.' [8] So now in the sight of all Israel, the assembly of the LORD, and in the hearing of our God, keep and seek out all the commandments of the LORD your God, so that you may possess this good land and leave it as an inheritance to your descendants forever. [9] As for you, Solomon my son, know the God of your father and serve Him wholeheartedly and with a willing mind, for the LORD searches every heart and understands the intent of every thought. If you seek Him, He will be found by you; but if you forsake Him, He will reject you forever.

[10] "Consider now that the LORD has chosen you to build a house for the sanctuary. Be strong and do it." [11] Then David gave his son Solomon the plans for the portico of the temple, its buildings, storehouses, upper rooms, inner rooms, and the room for the mercy seat. [12] The plans contained everything David had in mind for the courts of the house of the LORD, for all the surrounding rooms, for the treasuries of the house of God and of the dedicated things, [13] for the divisions of the priests and Levites, for all the work of service in the house of the LORD, and for all the articles of service in the house of the LORD: [14] the weight of all the gold articles for every kind of service; the weight of all the silver articles for every kind of service; [15] the weight of the gold lampstands and their lamps, including the weight of each lampstand and its lamps; the weight of each silver lampstand and its lamps, according to the use of each lampstand; [16] the weight of gold for each table of showbread, and of silver for the silver tables; [17] the weight of the pure gold for the forks, sprinkling bowls, and pitchers; the weight of each gold dish; the weight of each silver bowl; [18] the weight of the refined gold for the altar of incense; and the plans for the chariot of the gold cherubim that spread their wings and overshadowed the ark of the covenant of the LORD. [19] "All this," said David, "all the details of this plan, the LORD has made clear to me in writing by His hand upon me." [20] David also said to Solomon his son, "Be strong and courageous, and do it. Do not be afraid or discouraged, for the LORD God, my God, is with you. He will neither fail you nor forsake you before all the work for the service of the house of the LORD is finished." [21] "The divisions of the priests and Levites are ready for all the service of the house of God, and every willing man of every skill will be at your disposal for the work. The officials and all the people are fully at your command."

29 Then King David said to the whole assembly, "My son Solomon, the one whom God has chosen, is young and inexperienced. The task is great because this palace is not for man, but for the LORD God." [2] Now with all my ability I have made provision for the house of my God—gold for the gold articles, silver for the silver, bronze for the bronze, iron for the iron, and wood for the wood, as well as onyx for the settings, turquoise, stones of various colors, all kinds of precious stones, and slabs of marble—all in abundance. [3] Moreover, because of my delight in the house of my God, I now give for it my personal treasures of gold and silver, over and above all that I have provided for this holy temple: [4] three thousand talents of gold (the gold of Ophir) and seven thousand talents of refined silver, to overlay the walls of the buildings, [5] "for the gold work and the silver work, and for all the work to be done by the craftsmen. Now who will volunteer to consecrate himself to the LORD today?" [6] Then the leaders of the households, the officers of the tribes of Israel, the commanders of thousands and of hundreds, and the officials in charge of the king's work gave willingly. [7] Toward the service of God's house they gave 5,000 talents and 10,000 darics of gold, 10,000 talents of silver, 18,000 talents of bronze, and 100,000 talents of iron. [8] Whoever had precious stones gave them to the treasury of the house of the LORD, under the care of Jehiel the Gershonite. [9] And the people rejoiced at the willing response of their leaders, for they had given to the LORD freely and wholeheartedly. And King David also rejoiced greatly.

[10] Then David blessed the LORD in the sight of all the assembly and said: "May You be blessed, O LORD, God of our father Israel, from everlasting to everlasting." [11] Yours, O LORD, is the greatness and the power and the glory and the splendor and the majesty, for everything in heaven and on earth belongs to You. Yours, O LORD, is the kingdom, and You are exalted as head over all. [12] Both riches and honor come from You, and You are the ruler over all. In Your hands are power

and might to exalt and give strength to all. [13] Now therefore, our God, we give You thanks, and we praise Your glorious name. [14] But who am I, and who are my people, that we should be able to give as generously as this? For everything comes from You, and from Your own hand we have given to You. [15] For we are foreigners and strangers in Your presence, as were all our forefathers. Our days on earth are like a shadow, without hope. [16] O LORD our God, from Your hand comes all this abundance that we have provided to build You a house for Your holy Name, and all of it belongs to You. [17] I know, my God, that You test the heart and delight in uprightness. All these things I have given willingly and with an upright heart, and now I have seen Your people who are present here giving joyfully and willingly to You. [18] O LORD, God of our fathers Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, keep this desire forever in the intentions of the hearts of Your people, and direct their hearts toward You. [19] "And give my son Solomon a whole heart to keep and carry out all Your commandments, decrees, and statutes, and to build Your palace for which I have made provision."

[20] Then David said to the whole assembly, "Blessed be the LORD your God." So the whole assembly blessed the LORD, the God of their fathers. They bowed down and paid homage to the LORD and to the king. [21] The next day they offered sacrifices and presented burnt offerings to the LORD: a thousand bulls, a thousand rams, and a thousand lambs, along with their drink offerings, and other sacrifices in abundance for all Israel. [22] That day they ate and drank with great joy in the presence of the LORD. Then, for a second time, they designated David's son Solomon as king, anointing him before the LORD as ruler, and Zadok as the priest. [23] So Solomon sat on the throne of the LORD as king in place of his father David. He prospered, and all Israel obeyed him. [24] All the officials and mighty men, as well as all of King David's sons, pledged their allegiance to King Solomon. [25] The LORD highly exalted Solomon in the sight of all Israel and bestowed on him royal majesty such as had not been bestowed on any king in Israel before him. [26] David son of Jesse was king over all Israel. [27] The length of David's reign over Israel was forty years—seven years in Hebron and thirty-three years in Jerusalem. [28] He died at a ripe old age, full of years, riches, and honor, and his son Solomon reigned in his place. [29] Now the acts of King David, from first to last, are indeed written in the Chronicles of Samuel the Seer, the Chronicles of Nathan the Prophet, and the Chronicles of Gad the Seer, [30] together with all the details of his reign, his might, and the circumstances that came upon him and Israel and all the kingdoms of the lands.

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